

Debian 9 'Stretch' will come with FFmpeg

The Debian project is finally making the move to FFmpeg from Libav. The developers have decided to make FFmpeg available by default on Debian 9.0 Stretch, as a replacement for Libav. The proposal was made a while back, and there are some very good arguments backing this decision. The main one seems to revolve around security, as FFmpeg is way ahead of Libav in this respect. Obviously, Debian must put security above all other considerations, so its move seems logical.



Libav and FFmpeg are both multimedia frameworks for manipulating media files and do pretty much the same thing. Still, switching to a more secure platform is always a priority for Debian.

"After a careful review of all the pros and cons, we, the Debian Multimedia Maintainers team, have finally decided to switch from Libav to FFmpeg as provider for the libav* multimedia libraries. We'll try our best to make this happen in time for Stretch. Finally, we want to thank Reinhard Tartler very much for the tremendous efforts he put in while serving as both upstream developer and Debian's primary maintainer for Libav in the past four years. We all owe him a great debt of gratitude for that," said Alessio Treglia from the Debian Multimedia Maintainers team.

get to documentation. Those at ownCloud say their documentation has vastly improved in the last month.

This ownCloud release brings much improved performance, with up to 4x faster uploads and downloads, and immensely faster file manipulation. Better scalability through improved handling of parallel requests means ownCloud can now handle up to 50 per cent more active users on each ownCloud Server instance.

OwnCloud Documents has been updated to the latest upstream version of WebODF. This upgrade introduces new features such as annotation support and new styling capabilities.

The ownCloud team has also added external key management capabilities, which provides improved reliability and management and sets the stage for future encryption enhancements.

Linux Mint 17.2 'Rafaela' is out

Linux Mint 17.2 is a long term support (LTS) release, which will be supported until 2019. It comes with updated software and brings refinements and many



new features to make your desktop experience more exciting.

The latest release has Cinnamon 2.6 and addresses the issue of desktop freezes. On supported hardware, Cinnamon now uses a newer 'cogl' API. This change is known to prevent

some of the causes of desktop freezes observed in earlier releases. In case of a freeze, or if you need to restart Cinnamon for any reason, you can now do so via a keyboard shortcut. The default key combination is Ctrl+Alt+Escape. Pressing this combination of keys restarts Nemo and the 'cinnamon-settings-daemon' in case they had crashed, and launches a brand new instance of the Cinnamon desktop. Unlike Ctrl+Alt+Backspace, which terminates your session and brings you back to the login screen, Ctrl+Alt+Escape simply restarts Cinnamon itself, which means your session is exactly as it was. You don't lose any work and all your windows and applications remain open.

Other improvements include logind/consolekit-upower support, better responsiveness, load times and CPU usage, multi-monitor and multi-panel support, improved panels and applets, and a more meaningful Update Manager. It also has better support for UEFI, Nvidia and Optimus cards. LibreOffice has been upgraded to version 4.4.3. HPLIP has been upgraded to version 3.15.2 for more HP printers to be recognised and supported. Linux Mint 17.2 features Cinnamon 2.6, MDM 2.0, Linux kernel 3.16 and an Ubuntu 14.04 package base. Linux Mint 17.2 Rafaela has also been released with MATE 1.10.

After the official release of both the MATE and Cinnamon flavours, the upgrade options have been made available for the users of older versions.

The only major difference is that the Linux Mint upgrade system doesn't